



Move the hand

The hands of the doomsday clock are scheduled to move any moment, now. Fact or fiction? <http://digit.in/doomsdclk>



iRig

The iRig puts the power of a recording studio in a sleek array of portable devices that hook up to your smartphone <http://digit.in/irigport>

Bazaar

Xiaomi Redmi Note 4G

Solid but not noteworthy



Features	78
Display	71
Performance.....	62
Value	80

Specifications

Display: 5.5 inch 720p IPS display; **Processor:** 1.6 Ghz Qualcomm Snapdragon 400 quad-core SoC; **RAM:** 2GB; **Storage:** 8GB, expandable to 32GB; **Battery:** 3,100 mAh; **Operating System:** Android 4.4 KitKat with MiUI 5

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Following the Ericsson case, Xiaomi has only one version of the Redmi Note to sell in the Indian market. That makes the Redmi Note 4G all the more important for the company. In addition, with the arrival of the Yu Yureka, it is no longer void of competition. The MediaTek SoC in the 3G version of the Note is replaced in this one by the Snapdragon 400 SoC and the 4G version also runs on KitKat instead of Jelly Bean, even though MiUI 5 remains as before.

If you read our review of the Redmi Note 3G last month, you would know we weren't impressed with the battery draining MediaTek SoC. That is one area that the Snapdragon 400 excels at. In fact, the Redmi Note's battery capacity is better than the Yu



Price
₹9,999



Yureka as well, if only slightly.

On the other hand, the performance of the device is lower than the 3G counterpart and Yureka. That and the fact that the Snapdragon 400, as good as it is, is still an outdated SoC, is what makes the Redmi Note 4G the inferior device when compared to the Yu Yureka smartphone.

Like its predecessor, the Redmi Note 4G remains a satisfactory smartphone in the budget segment, but it's no longer the best in its class. The Yu Yureka is a more powerful and also happens to be priced ₹1,000 lesser than the Note. So, if it's 4G that you want, then the Redmi Note, while satisfactory, isn't

the best buy anymore.

Prasid Banerjee

Merlin ScreenCast Streamer

Sleek and well built



Features	80
Performance.....	70
Build	75

Specifications

CPU: AM8251; **RAM:** DDR3 128MB; **Memory:** 128MB; **Supported protocols:** DLNA, Airplay, EZcast, Miracast; **Wi-Fi:** 802.11n; **Dimensions:** 33 x 87 x 7mm; **Supported OS:** Android 4+, iOS6+, Mac 10.7, Win XP/7/8; **Warranty:** 1 Year

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EZCast based HDMI streamers are always easier to work with. Though the firmware is far from being polished, it seems to be the one actively working towards improving the user experience. The hardware is pretty much the same for all EZCast streamers unless you wish to buy the EZCast Pro which has slightly better hardware. We'd tested another such streamer about a year back and it was nice to see a good deal of improvement since then. The hardware is the same but the cost is slightly higher than what we'd looked at earlier. Even when connected to the streamer directly and not through a router we did experience a fair amount of stuttering in heavy applications so you'll need a mobile device with decent specifications to eliminate any bottlenecks at your end.

So it comes down to how well the firmware has been implemented.

Despite the slew of improvements made to the software there are still some glaring bugs which can make the experience a bit cumbersome. The game scanning feature is ridiculously slow and there is no option to rotate the screen. When accessing PDFs, the screen goes black completely if the mobile device is rotated to change to landscape mode. Lastly, advanced Wi-Fi settings aren't available so if you

wished to perform a few QoS modifications then you need to do the same at the router level.

What we liked about the product is that it comes with an HDMI extension cable and a HDMI female-female receptacle. Since this is a niche category product it is essential that the product come with all accessories that may be needed to get it to work and Merlin seems to have hit the mark on that regards which makes the slight price increment justified.

Mithun Mohandas



Price
₹3,800